Welcome to My STAR

My STAR is the individual's place to share experiences in their own way. Participation is voluntary; the person can choose an answer, skip a question, or stop.

The first time

1. With a helper if wanted, create and confirm a separate individual account, choose I am an Individual, and join the team using its code.

2. Choose a preferred display name and optional picture, and save Profile. Confirm the correct team group opens.

3. Explore the My STAR tiles together. Start with How I Feel or My Day, and show how to get back to My STAR.

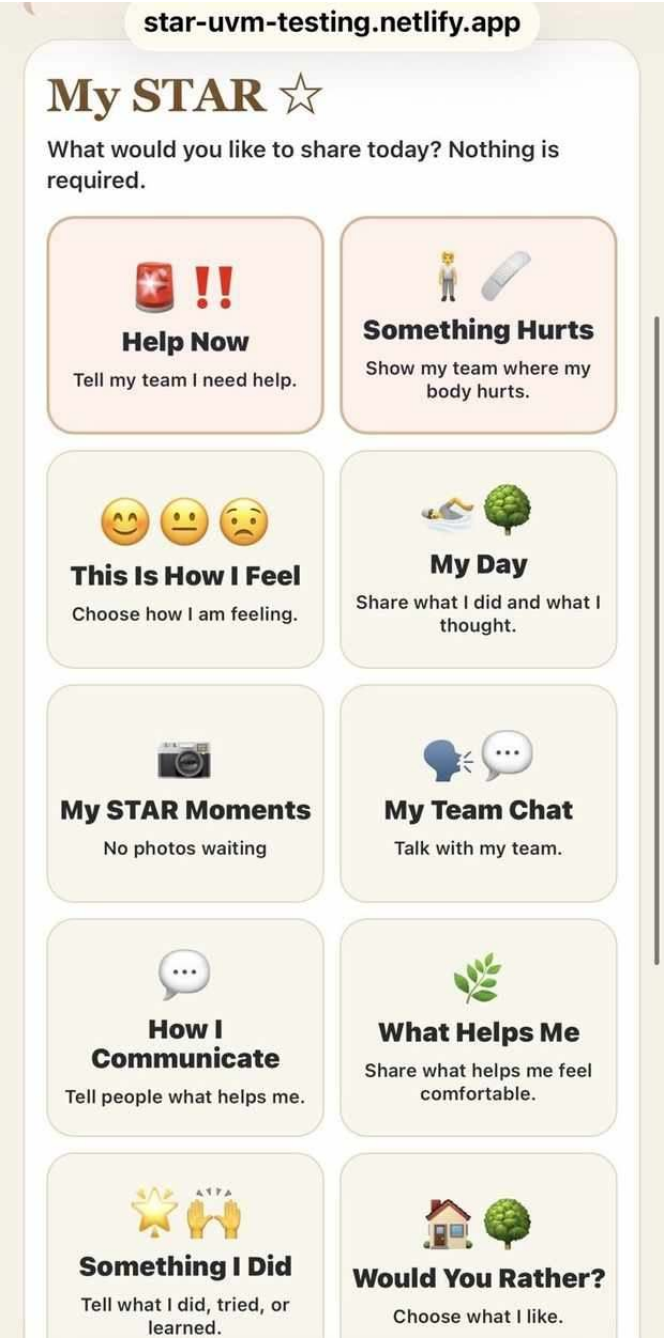
4. Try Read Aloud and Mic Setup. The person may type, talk, tap, point, or ask for help to enter the words they choose.

5. Show Help Now and Something Hurts first so the person knows how to tell the team something important. For immediate emergencies, get help from a nearby person or follow the emergency plan.

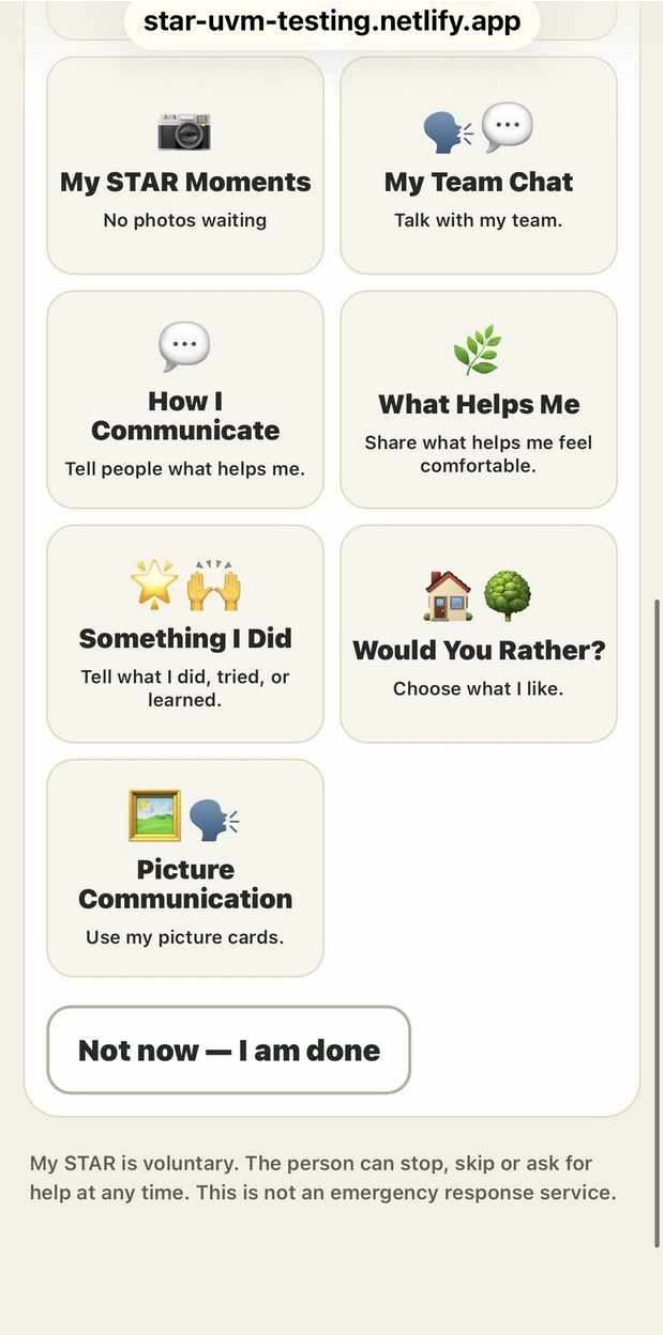
Helpful support means

Updated My STAR home — individual dashboard (November 2026)

My STAR uses two columns of large, touch-friendly picture tiles. Help Now and Something Hurts appear first so they are easy to find. Next are This Is How I Feel and My Day. Other tiles include My STAR Moments, My Team Chat, How I Communicate, What Helps Me, Something I Did, Would You Rather?, and Picture Communication. Tap a tile to open it. The person can stop by choosing Not now — I am done. The arrangement reduces scrolling without removing features.



My STAR — Help Now, Something Hurts, feelings, My Day and other tiles



My STAR — additional communication, Moments and choice tiles

- Read or show one option at a time, allow enough time to decide, and confirm before tapping on the person's behalf.
- Record the individual's own selection or words and mark Someone helped me answer when the screen asks.
- Do not turn skipped activities into a caregiver-selected answer. Caregiver observations belong in their own documentation.

Individual | Get to know My STAR

Tap a picture tile to share feelings, choices, or experiences, or to communicate with your team. The two-column layout keeps Help Now and Something Hurts at the top. Each tile opens its own guided activity.



App screenshots joined from top to bottom.

Find the tile you want

Read Aloud and Mic Setup Tap Read Aloud at the top to hear prompts. Tap Mic Setup to practice speaking into a text box. Follow the steps on page 12.

Help Now and Something Hurts Tell your team you need help or use the body map to show where it hurts. If you need immediate help, get someone nearby or follow your emergency plan.

How I Feel and My Day Pick a face to show how you feel or tell your team how your day went.

My Moments to Review Look at a photo and share what you thought about the activity.

Something I Did Share something you did, tried, or learned.

Talk to My Team Send a message or open the group chat.

Would You Rather? Use pictures to choose what you might like to do.

Picture Communication Use your picture cards to help say what you want to share.

Not now — I am done Stop whenever you want. You can come back another time.

My STAR | Daily use

For the individual and anyone helping them use STAR



How I Feel

1. Open My STAR and tap How I Feel. Pick the face that matches how you feel right now. The choices are Happy, Okay, Sad, Upset, Tired, and Not feeling good.
2. If someone helped you answer, check Someone helped me answer. Tap Done to save your choice. Tap Not now to skip.

If you are helping, read the choices aloud, wait, and let the person point, tap, or say their choice. If they ask you to tap for them, confirm their choice first.

My Day

1. Open My STAR and tap My Day. Think about an activity from today. Tap I liked it, It was okay, I did not like it, or Not today if you did not do the activity today.
2. To name the activity, tap the box under Which activity? and type its name, or tap Talk Instead and say it. If asked for microphone access, tap Allow. Check that your words appear in the box and fix them if needed. You can leave the box blank.
3. Check Someone helped me answer if you received help. Tap Done to save. Tap Not now if you want to skip the check-in.

Ask for help or show where it hurts

Tap Help Now or Something Hurts in the first row of My STAR to send a message to your team. The full instructions are in the Help Now and Something Hurts sections that follow.

Share something you did

1. Open Something I Did when you want to tell your team about something you did, tried, or learned.
2. Describe what happened in your own words. If the screen asks whether someone helped, say how you did it and what help you used.
3. Tap Done to send the observation for review. The admin can review it and decide whether it relates to an ISA outcome.

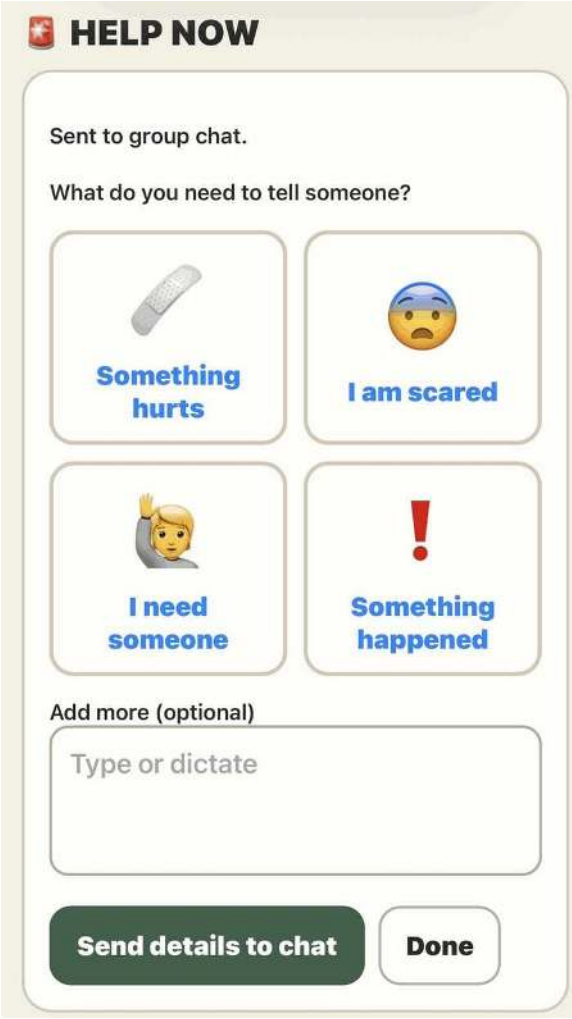
Explore what you might like to do

1. Open Would You Rather? and look at the picture choices. Take one choice at a time, such as whether you'd like to be inside or outside.
2. Follow the choices until you find an activity that interests you. Use the option for something else or stop if the choices don't fit.

If you're helping, give the person time to look and respond. Record their selection or words as they communicated them. Keep your interpretation separate.

Individual | Help Now

Use Help Now to tell your whole team directly that you need help. You can do this yourself or ask someone to help you choose a picture or enter your words. Your team gets the alert in Group Chat and on the caregiver or admin Home dashboard.



What to tap

1. Tap Help Now. Open My STAR and tap the red Help Now tile in the first row. Look for “Sent to group chat.” That means your first message went to the team.

2. Choose a picture if you want. Tap Something hurts, I am scared, I need someone, or Something happened to tell the team more.

3. Add words if you want. Tap the Add more box. Type your words, use dictation if available, or ask a helper to enter the words you choose.

4. Send the details. Tap Send details to chat if you want the team to see your picture choice or words. Tap Done when you’re finished. If you only wanted to send the first alert, you can tap Done without adding details.

If you need help right away, get someone nearby or follow your emergency plan.

Individual | Something Hurts

Use Something Hurts to tell your whole team directly and show where it hurts. A helper can read the choices or help you tap the spot you point to. Your team gets the alert in Group Chat and on the caregiver or admin Home dashboard.



What to tap

1. Tap Something Hurts. Open My STAR and tap Something Hurts in the first row. Look for “Sent to group chat.”

2. Choose Front or Back. Tap the button for the side of your body that hurts.

3. Tap the spot. Tap the circle closest to where it hurts. If symptom choices appear, pick one that matches how it feels, or send just the body location.

4. Show whether you had help. Check Someone helped me answer if someone helped you use the screen or choose your answer.

5. Send the details and finish. Tap Send details to chat to tell your team what you chose. Tap Done when you’re finished, or Not now to stop adding details. The first alert has already been sent.

If you need help right away, get someone nearby or follow your emergency plan.

Individual | Read Aloud and microphone

Use Read Aloud when you want STAR to speak. Use the microphone when you want your own words to appear in a text box. You can use either feature on its own.

Hear a prompt

1. **Open My STAR.** At the top of the dashboard, find Read Aloud beside Mic Setup.
2. **Turn it on.** If it says Read Aloud: OFF, tap it once so it says Read Aloud: ON. If it already says ON, leave it on.
3. **Try it with How I Feel.** Tap How I Feel and listen for the prompt to pick a face. If you want to finish the activity, pick a face and tap Done. To skip it, tap Not now.
4. **Turn it off when you want.** Return to My STAR and tap Read Aloud: ON. The button changes to Read Aloud: OFF. If you hear nothing while it is on, check your device volume and open the activity again.

Set up and test the microphone

1. **Open Mic Setup.** At the top of My STAR, tap Mic Setup. Ask a helper to stay with you the first time if you want.
2. **Start the test.** Find the Microphone test box and tap Talk Instead. If your phone or browser asks to use the microphone, tap Allow.
3. **Say a short phrase.** Try “I like music.” Look in the test box for your words and check that they match what you said. The practice words are not saved.
4. **Return to the dashboard.** Tap Back to My STAR when you’re finished. If no words appeared, try Talk Instead again. If access was blocked, a helper can check microphone permission for STAR in the browser’s site settings.

Speak into a text box during an activity

1. **Open an activity.** For example, open Something I Did. Look for Talk Instead near the text box.
2. **Tap Talk Instead and speak.** Say what you want to share. If the button says Stop when you finish speaking, tap it and wait for the words to appear.
3. **Check your words before saving.** Tap the text box to fix any mistakes. You can also type your whole answer. When the words are right and you’re ready to share them, tap Done.

Individual | Moments, photos and communication

For the individual and a supporter; caregivers may also add Moments and review My Month. For How I Communicate and What Helps Me, see Part 6.



Look back at a Moment

1. Open My Moments to Review. A photo may also appear after a mood check-in.
2. Look at one photo at a time. Choose how you felt about the activity and whether you'd like to do it again.
3. Add your own words if you'd like. Choose Not now if you want to return to it later.

Add a Moment for someone to review

1. Open Add a Moment and select the individual before uploading a photo or using the camera.
2. Enter a short activity label and category. Add a caregiver observation if it helps explain what happened.
3. Save it for the individual to review. Keep the activity description simple enough for the person to recognize it later.

Review a month of experiences

1. Open My Month, choose the individual and month, then select a photo.
2. Read what the person shared about the activity and look at the support they used. Completed Moments show caregiver observations separately.
3. During a team review, invite the individual to choose a photo to discuss. Ask whether they want to do the activity again or change something about it.

Talk to your team and use picture cards

1. From My STAR, open Talk to My Team. Choose Group Chat to communicate with the active group, or open Picture Communication to use picture cards.
2. In Group Chat, type your message and tap Send. In Picture Communication, choose a picture that helps communicate what you want to say.